

ONE PLANT, MANY TEAS

Many types of tea are produced worldwide, all of which come from the same plant species. Each tea is produced differently and has unique features that affect flavor and strength. Here, they are grouped under the six main types. From sweet and fragrant to chocolatey and nutty, there is a spectrum of flavors to enjoy.

GREEN TEA

Green tea is unoxidized and most closely resembles the original plucked leaf—a small springtime leaf bud that contains abundant nutrients and oils sent up from the roots after a period of winter dormancy. Green tea is admired for its freshness and fleeting nature (it has a short shelf life of 6–8 months). The most prized green teas in China are referred to as pre-Qing Ming, or “before the spring festival,” which falls in early April. Green tea comes in different shapes—flat, needlelike, curled like a snail, rolled into balls, or in fine twists.

